

CRYSIS

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ugust 7, 2020. An asteroid crashes on Lingshan Island in the Phillipean Sea. August 14, 2020. A distress call from a group of archaeologists who were investigating the crash zone is intercepted. It seems the area is swarming with Korean troops. An artifact of unknown origin has been uncovered from the crash site, and the scientists have been detained to analyse its properties. A few days later, you and your elite team are sent to rescue the scientists, and find out what the heck is going on.

Things get plenty nasty after you see a teammate who's been torn to shreds by some Unknown Entity.

Essentially a "sandbox" game, *Crysis*' brilliance lies in its simplicity. Huge levels, missions and complete freedom—do as you will! Your Nanosuit is your best friend, and will give you an array of powers—from boosting your armour during fire-fights, to cloaking you for stealth kills and recon and increasing your speed or strength. The suit runs off an energy pack, so you won't be able to use these powers indefinitely—run too fast in stealth mode and your power meter will drop like pins in a bowling alley. Weapons and weapon mods like scopes, laser sights, and damage modifiers are aplenty.

Enemy AI is ferocious, even on easy settings. They'll flank you, grenade you and take pot shots at you from behind cover. They'll also (quite irritatingly) call for reinforcements.

Although your suit makes things easier, you'll be surprised how quickly your health and armour nosedives if a couple of Koreans catch you in their sights.

The level of detail that *Crysis* achieves is nothing short of incredible. Lush jungle environments come to life, dappled sunlight through trees and the corona effects of dust and fog will dazzle you. Battles are spectacular, with smoke and flame spewing from weapons, debris and concussions from explosions—all extraordinarily life-like. The environment's completely destructible too: imagine machine gunning a palm tree to have to fall on a couple of opponents and crush them! Very immersive, and very, very realistic, I say.

The only minus point—*Crysis* eats most CPUs and GPUs for breakfast. In fact, if you want to experience *Crysis the way it's meant to be played* (no pun) then you better have a GeForce 8 series or a Radeon 2xxx series card—preferably two! It'll be worth the upgrade.

The long and engrossing storyline has three distinct parts (no, we're not going to spoil it for you). The multiplayer component isn't much with its paltry selection of maps, but the single player experience is frantic fun. Genre defining? Yes! Genre redefining? No. *Crysis* takes the best components of *Far Cry* and adds a few of its own—which isn't a bad thing, although there's nothing in the way of path-breaking differences.

I have two bits of advice: upgrade, and play this game...

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Rating: 8/10
Developer: Crytek Studios
Publisher: EA
Price: Rs 1,000

GAMING PC

XFX GeForce 8800 Ultra,
Intel Core 2 Duo E6600,
4 GB DDR2 RAM